A PROPOSAL FOR OFFICIAL CLUB RECOGNITION

INSTITUTE OF

Conversations

M N I T

"Where Ideas Meet."

A student-led institutional platform for research-driven interviews, long-form conversations, and the documented voices of MNIT Jaipur.

Submitted to: **Dean, Student Welfare, MNIT Jaipur**

Proposed by: **Namit Shastry** — B.Tech Civil Engineering, 2026–30

Student Advisor: *To be assigned upon approval*

Date: **September 2026**

MNIT JAIPUR · 2026

Executive Summary

MNIT Jaipur has clubs for debate, media, photography, and filmmaking — and individual bodies such as E-Cell already produce podcast-style content in support of their own mandate. What MNIT does not yet have is a dedicated, institute-wide platform that trains students in the craft of research, interviewing, moderation, and long-form conversation — and builds a permanent, structured archive of the people and ideas shaping this institution.

The **Institute of Conversations, MNIT** is proposed to fill exactly that gap. It is not a content channel. It is a student-run institution — with its own leadership structure, recruitment cycle, training curriculum, and succession pipeline — of which podcasting is simply the flagship output.

> *The Institute of Conversations does not seek to create* **another podcast** *at MNIT Jaipur. It seeks to build an* **institutional ecosystem** *for conversations, interviewing, research, and storytelling — with podcasting as its flagship medium.*

This proposal requests official club recognition, a faculty advisor, a dedicated recording space, and a first-year budget of **₹2,17,767** to establish foundational infrastructure and run a structured pilot across one academic year.

What We Are Asking For

- Official recognition as an institute-wide student club
- A faculty advisor from MNIT's academic body
- A dedicated or fixed-slot recording room
- First-year budget: **₹2,17,767** (one-time + operations)

What We Will Deliver

- 5 flagship episodes in the first 3 months, incl. the Dean and JAA President
- A trained, cross-branch team of ~40 students across 7 departments
- A permanent institutional archive of MNIT voices
- Direct, recurring interaction between MNIT students and visiting industry leaders

Why This Is a New Institution — Not a Redesign

The most important question this proposal must answer is simple: *"E-Cell already runs a podcast, and JAA already engages alumni — why do we need a new club?"* The answer is that both existing efforts are **outputs of other bodies**, built to serve those bodies' own mandate. This proposal is not a better version of either. It is a different kind of institution altogether.

Dimension	E-Cell Podcast	JAA (Alumni Association)	Institute of Conversations
Core purpose	Entrepreneurship content for E-Cell's ecosystem	Alumni relations & institutional engagement	Institute-wide skill-building in research, interviewing & storytelling
Who it serves	E-Cell members & startup-focused students	Alumni & institute administration	Students across **every** branch — Civil, CSE, Mech, EE, Architecture, Management
Structure	Content sub-team within E-Cell	Alumni-facing association, not a training body	Independent club — 4 senior posts, 7 departments, full recruitment cycle
Output	Episodes, when produced	Alumni meets, newsletters, occasional interviews	Training curriculum + episodes + live events + a permanent archive
Continuity	Tied to E-Cell's annual leadership	Institutional, not training-focused	Built-in succession pipeline: Researcher → Producer → Host → Executive → Leadership

> *"E-Cell has already proven that podcasting works at MNIT. That is exactly why the skill deserves an institute-wide home — not a reason to leave it inside one club."*

✕ We are NOT

- **Debate Club** — we don't run competitive argumentation
- **Mass & Media / English Press** — we don't cover campus news
- **Film Making Club** — we don't primarily produce films
- **Photography Club** — we don't primarily shoot photography
- **E-Cell's content team** — we are not entrepreneurship-only

✓ We ARE

- A structured platform for **research-driven interviewing**
- A **cross-branch** training institution — open to all disciplines
- A body with its own **recruitment, training, and leadership succession**
- A builder of a **permanent institutional archive** of MNIT's people
- A collaborator — E-Cell and JAA become founding ecosystem partners

Why This Serves MNIT's Own Interests

Beyond student development, this club creates a direct, physical channel between MNIT and the outside world — one that benefits the institute's visibility, industry relationships, and student exposure in ways a passive content channel cannot.

1. **Industry experts physically enter MNIT.** Every recorded conversation with a founder, alumnus, or industry leader means that person walks onto campus, meets students informally, and experiences the institute directly — not a remote video call. Repeated visits build a habit of engagement between MNIT and the professional world outside it.

2. **Guests return more often.** A structured, professional recording experience gives visiting guests a reason to come back — for a second conversation, a mentorship session, or a recruitment visit — turning one-time visits into ongoing relationships with the institute.

3. **Students get direct access.** The students producing and hosting each episode — researchers, hosts, tech crew — get in-person time with founders, faculty, and administrators they would otherwise never meet, building networks that outlast their four years at MNIT.

4. **A permanent institutional asset.** Every episode becomes part of a searchable, growing archive of MNIT's faculty, alumni, and guest conversations — a resource future students, admissions material, and the institute's own communications can draw on indefinitely.

5. **External visibility for MNIT.** Well-produced conversations, distributed publicly, position MNIT alongside institutes that already treat long-form content as a serious extension of their brand — raising the institute's profile with prospective students, recruiters, and the alumni network.

6. **A talent pipeline, not a one-off team.** Because the club runs a structured recruitment and training cycle every year, MNIT gains a self-renewing student body skilled in research, communication, and production — without repeated institutional investment in retraining from scratch.

Club Structure — 40 Members

The club is structured as a genuine institution rather than a flat group — with a President at the helm, a Student Advisor providing peer-level institutional continuity, 7 functional departments each led by an executive, and a clear reporting chain that gives the Dean's office exactly two points of accountability.

PRESIDENT — Institutional relationships, vision, final sign-off

STUDENT ADVISOR — Institutional continuity & mentorship

Chief Operating Officer (COO)
Internal operations

Head of Content & Editorial
Editorial quality

General Secretary
Records & admin

Outreach Lead
Reports direct to President

Tech Lead

Logistics Lead

Decor & Set Design Lead

Media & Promotion Lead

Head Host — reports to Head of Content & Editorial

Research Lead — reports to Head of Content & Editorial

Post / Department	Executive	Function
Institutional Continuity	Student Advisor	Peer mentorship, continuity across academic years, guidance for the President and executives
Podcast / Hosting	Head Host	On-air hosting, interview delivery, live moderation
Research	Research Lead	Guest research, question design, episode briefs
Tech	Tech Lead	Recording, camera, audio, editing
Logistics	Logistics Lead	Scheduling, hospitality, event-day coordination
Decor & Set Design	Set Design Lead	Studio look, branding, physical setup
Outreach & Guest Relations	Outreach Lead	Guest pipeline — alumni, founders, faculty
Media & Promotion	Promotion Lead	Social media, clips, posting calendar

Total headcount: 4 senior posts + 7 department executives + ~28 members ≈ 39–40 students, guided by one Student Advisor.

Training Curriculum & Activity Calendar

Week 1 — Orientation & Foundations

A physical, institute-wide orientation covering the club's vision, format, and approach — followed by one online session per department, run by that department's executive, covering tools and workflow.

Aim: give every member the tools and knowledge to work from day one.

Week 2 — Applied Practice

Each department completes a sample assignment (a mock guest brief, a practice recording, a draft outreach email) and presents it for group review. A full internal "dry-run" episode is recorded to stress-test the entire production chain before any real guest is involved.

Aim: convert Week 1 theory into hands-on competence.

Weeks 3–4 — Production Begins

Real episode production starts. Outreach and Research continue running the guest pipeline in parallel, so scheduling for later episodes never stalls production of the current one.

Ongoing — Recruitment & Visibility

The club's website and social media are showcased during recruitment to attract members across all branches, and continue running through the semester to build public visibility for each episode.

EPISODE PLAN — FIRST 5 RELEASES

#	Guest	Significance
1	Prof. Narayana Prasad Padhy, Dean	Flagship launch episode — institutional credibility from day one
2	Dr. Ashish Dutta Sharma, President, JAA	Alumni association partnership showcased
3	MNIT Alumni Guest	Alumni-industry crossover conversation
4	Visiting Industry Expert (guest to MNIT)	External guest — fulfils cross-institutional reach
5	Faculty / Alumni guest via ongoing outreach	Continued pipeline momentum

3-Month Target: 5 Episodes | **≥1 Non-MNIT Guest** | **~40 Students Trained** | **1 Dry-Run + 5 Live Recordings**

06 · BUDGET

Proposed Budget — First Year

The budget is intentionally lean. This is a one-time infrastructure investment, not a recurring media production expense — the club expects to reduce institutional dependency from Year 2 onward through sponsorships and event partnerships.

A. ONE-TIME FOUNDATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Item	Qty	Cost (₹)
Canon EOS R50 + RF-S 18–45mm lens	1	**66,990**
Digitek DPTR-880 PRO fluid-head tripod	1	**2,999**
AmpliTank K688CT USB/XLR podcast microphone	2	**12,278**
Podcast table, 36–42 inch	1	**9,000**
Studio decoration & visual setup	—	**6,000**
Additional / buffer microphone	1	**2,500**
Acoustic foam panels + door/curtain treatment	—	**8,000**
Cables, adapters, small accessories & contingency	—	**10,000**
Total One-Time Setup		**₹1,17,767**

B. FIRST-YEAR OPERATIONS

Category	Annual Provision (₹)
Guest logistics & hospitality	**20,000**
Workshops & student training	**15,000**
Live conversation events	**20,000**
Promotion, design & printing	**10,000**
Software & digital tools	**10,000**
Local transportation / logistics	**10,000**
Equipment maintenance	**5,000**
General contingency	**10,000**
Total Operations	**₹1,00,000**

Grand Total — First Year: **₹2,17,767**

Note: Camera coverage for the second/guest angle is supplemented using existing personal smartphones at no added cost. Lighting relies on natural and existing room lighting rather than a dedicated purchase, keeping the ask lean without compromising recording quality.

Success Metrics & Risk Management

SUCCESS METRICS — FIRST 3 MONTHS

Metric	Target
Episodes published	5
Students trained across all departments	35–40
Guests onboarded	5
Non-MNIT guest episodes	≥ 1
Department retention (active at end of month 3)	≥ 80%
Audience watch time / short-form reach	Baseline tracked for future targets
Faculty / alumni post-episode satisfaction	Collected via feedback form

RISK & MITIGATION

Risk	Mitigation
Guest cancels close to recording date	Maintain a 2-guest buffer in the outreach pipeline at all times
Audio / technical failure during recording	Mandatory dry-run in Week 2; full equipment check 24 hrs before every session
Low member retention after recruitment	Structured Week 1–2 onboarding keeps early engagement high; executives track attendance
Inexperienced hosting affects guest experience	Head Host personally leads the first 2 flagship episodes; mock interviews in Week 2
Room / equipment unavailable on recording day	Fixed weekly recording slot pre-booked for the semester, not ad hoc
Editorial or reputational missteps	Head of Content & Editorial reviews and signs off on every episode before publishing

Space Requirement & Closing

RECORDING SPACE REQUIREMENT

The club requests one dedicated or regularly bookable room, approximately 150–200 sq. ft., available at a fixed weekly slot for recording. A fixed slot — rather than ad hoc bookings — reflects institutional permanence rather than an improvised setup.

In-Room Setup

- Podcast table with 2 chairs
- Tripod-mounted camera facing the table
- 2 podcast microphones + 1 buffer mic
- A laptop for recording/monitoring
- Water bottle set on the table for guest comfort

Ambience & Acoustics

- Institute/club branding backdrop for a clean, official look
- Adequate natural or existing room lighting
- A door that closes properly for noise isolation
- Curtains/carpet where available, to naturally aid acoustics

Exact room specifications to be finalized in consultation with the Dean's office based on space availability.

CLOSING STATEMENT

MNIT Jaipur already has clubs for debate, media, and film. What it does not yet have is its own institutional platform for documenting the people and ideas shaping this community — the kind that leading technical institutes are increasingly building for themselves. This proposal asks not "should MNIT have another podcast," but whether MNIT should have its own institution for conversation, memory, and voice — built by its own students, for the long term.

Namit Shastry Proposer & President-Designate	Student Advisor (To be assigned)	Dean, Student Welfare MNIT Jaipur